

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE · CONFIDENTIAL — FOR FAMILY
REVIEW



The Architecture of Grace

BOOK ONE · THE FOUNDATION

Home Edition

FOR FAMILIES · GRADES K-2

The complete year-long curriculum — every lesson,
undiluted — re-engineered for delivery by a parent at
home, one conversation at a time.

FREE PREVIEW

This free preview includes the parent's opening letter, how to use the book, the
crisis & safety quick-reference, and the first complete lesson — read it end to end.
The full 4 units · 28 lessons are available in the Store.

Before You Begin

A letter to the parent of an autistic child in Kindergarten, 1st, or 2nd grade

This book hands you the entire Architecture of Grace · Foundation **curriculum — nothing simplified, nothing left out.** What changes is the delivery. In school a teacher runs these lessons with a class and a puppet named Sammy. Here, you are the teacher, your kitchen table is the classroom, and the work happens in small, real moments.

Your child is at the age where the most important sentence of this whole curriculum gets built: “A mistake is something I did — not who I am.” Autistic children often arrive having absorbed the opposite — corrected more, misread more, praised less. This curriculum exists to interrupt the conclusion that something is wrong with them. Delivered gently at home, it can do that work before it hardens.

WHAT WE NEED TO TELL YOU — DIRECTLY

Autistic children are at elevated risk for self-harm and suicidal thoughts — not because of autism itself, but because of bullying, sensory overload, the exhaustion of masking, and being chronically misunderstood. This can begin young. If your child tells you, in any way — words, drawings, behavior — that they don't want to be here, take it seriously the first time. Don't argue. Don't ask why. Get help.

A few things this book asks of you:

- ◆ **When the school day ends in a crash — believe it.** The meltdown at 3:30 is the bill for holding it together until 3:00 — the cost of masking, not defiance.
- ◆ **Let the mask come off at home.** Stimming is not a problem. Needing quiet is not rude. Unmasking in your kitchen means your home is safe.
- ◆ **Believe their read of the world.** Autistic children are more likely to be disbelieved when they report being hurt. Don't be the adult who adds to that.
- ◆ **When a lesson is bigger than you — say so.** “This one is hard. Let's ask your counselor.” That is not failing. It models exactly what this curriculum teaches.

ONE MORE THING

You are not failing if your child goes quiet. You are not failing if a lesson takes three tries, or three months. You are reading this. You are trying. That is the work.

How to Use This Book

A flip book — one complete lesson per spread, in any order you like

There are **28 lessons**, grouped into 4 units, exactly mirroring the school curriculum. You do not have to teach them in order. Open to a lesson, read it once, and let it surface over the week — at meals, in the car, at bedtime.

Every lesson is built from the same six parts — once you know the shape of one, you know all 28:

① CORE DIRECT INSTRUCTION — HOME DELIVERY

The actual school lesson — objective, concepts, and steps intact — rewritten for one child and one adult at home. “Sammy” can be any stuffed animal your child chooses.

② THE AUTISM LENS

Three fixed supports: Make It Literal & Concrete, Sensory Regulation (matched to the lesson’s emotional load), and Universal Design for Communication.

③ ELITE CONVERSATION STARTERS

Low-pressure, one-question prompts tagged to the natural moments of a day — each paired with a script to model on yourself first.

④ PRINTABLE VISUAL ASSETS & CHARTS

Ready-to-print anchor charts and home tools — fridge-and-binder versions of the classroom’s visuals.

▲ SAFETY & ESCALATION

On every lesson: a clear line for when to bring in a professional. On high-stakes lessons this band grows — and tells you plainly when a conversation belongs to your child’s counselor, not to you alone.

✦ PARENT REFLECTION

One private question after each lesson. Not homework. A place to put what the lesson stirred up — because it will.

IF YOU ONLY HAVE THREE MINUTES

Read the Crisis & Safety page next. Then read Lesson 1 (Who Am I?) and Lesson 5 (Oops vs. I Am Bad). Those three pages are the foundation of everything else.

If You Need Help Right Now

Crisis & safety numbers — fill in the local line before you ever need it

988	Suicide & Crisis Lifeline — call or text · 24/7 · free
741741	Crisis Text Line — text HOME · for when speaking isn't possible
911	Immediate danger. If you can, ask for a CIT-trained officer and say your child is autistic.
—	Your local mobile crisis line — write it here now: _____

A NOTE ON CALLING 911

Police interactions can be dangerous for autistic people if officers are not trained. When possible, call mobile crisis, your pediatrician, or 988 first. Reserve 911 for immediate physical danger.

FOR THE PARENT OF AN AUTISTIC CHILD

Distress in young autistic children is often pre-verbal — it shows up in the body, in drawings, in sudden changes. Watch the whole child. When in doubt, ask your pediatrician or counselor. You are never overreacting by checking.

UNIT ONE



Knowing & Accepting Yourself

Before a child can be kind to anyone else, they need an honest, steady sense of who they are — and the bone-deep knowledge that they are more than their worst moment. That is the whole of Unit 1.

AUGUST – OCTOBER · SEVEN LESSONS

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1 · HOME EDITION

Who Am I?

STANDARD

The first lesson of the year — every child is unique, and that is the starting point

OBJECTIVE

CASEL FOCUS

Self-Awareness — personal qualities & a positive self-concept

Your child names at least two true things about themselves and grasps that every person is one of a kind.

VOCABULARY

who I am · special · unique · strength · different

AT HOME

20–25 min, or split across two sittings · Week 1

① Core Direct Instruction — Home Delivery

- 1 **BRING IN SAMMY · 3 MIN** Introduce the chosen animal/character first. **Sammy:** “I want to know all about YOU. Can you tell me one thing that makes you special?”
- 2 **BUILD THE IDENTITY WEB TOGETHER · 7 MIN** Center circle: **ME**. Five branches — Things I Love · Good At · Make Me Happy · Special About My Family · People Might Not Know. You model your own answers first.
- 3 **YOUR CHILD’S OWN WEB · 8 MIN** They draw or fill in their own mini-web. Every web is valid; every answer is right.
- 4 **SHARE ONE THING — THEIR CHOICE · 3 MIN** They hold up the web and share one thing. They never have to share more than they want.
- 5 **BEGIN THE HOME COMPACT · 2 MIN** “What do we need so this feels safe?” The four lines: what’s shared here stays here · you never have to share more than you choose · all feelings are okay · kind voices only.

② The Autism Lens

- ◆ **Make It Literal & Concrete** “One thing special” is abstract. Pre-load the five branches as a **choice board** (picture + word) so the task becomes pick from these, not invent from nothing. Do one branch per sitting if five is too many.
- ◆ **Sensory Regulation — tied to this theme** This is an exposure lesson; being seen is the load. Lower the demand: drawing counts, sit **side-by-side rather than face-to-face**, offer a fidget, choose a calm window. Opting out of sharing is built in, not a failure.
- ◆ **Universal Design for Communication Verbal:** says it. **AAC:** selects. **Point-to:** the choice board. **Draw:** the branch. **“Not sure”:** an honest, accepted answer.

③ Elite Conversation Starters

MEALTIME “If you made an Identity Web, what’s one thing you’d put on it? I’ll go first — mine is ____.”

CAR “Something most people don’t know about me is _____. What’s one for you?”

BEDTIME “Tell me one thing you’re good at. I loved watching you do it today.”

PARENT SCRIPT — MODEL IT ON YOURSELF

“Here’s mine: I love quiet mornings, I’m good at fixing things, and something people don’t know is I get nervous before phone calls. Your turn — or just one, if one’s enough.”

④ **Printable Visual Assets & Charts**

MY IDENTITY WEB

PRINT · POST ON THE FRIDGE OR IN THE BINDER · KEEP UP ALL YEAR ME Things I Love · Things I’m Good At · Things That Make Me Happy · Special About My Family · Something People Don’t Know

“ONE THING” CHOICE BOARD

HOME TOOL · FOR A CHILD WHO WOULD RATHER POINT THAN SPEAK animals · drawing · music · running · my family · building

▲ SAFETY & ESCALATION

Low-risk lesson. Watch only for a child who can name nothing and defaults to silence (early self-perception data — note it, don’t press), or an answer that names a real hurt or unsafe situation. If something concerning surfaces, that’s a conversation for your child’s counselor or pediatrician — not something to resolve inside this lesson.

✦ PARENT REFLECTION

Which branch did my child reach for first? Which made them go quiet? What did I learn about how they see themselves that I didn’t know this morning?

END OF FREE PREVIEW

That was Lesson 1 of 4 units • 28 lessons.

The free preview ends here — you've just read the parent's letter, the orientation, the crisis & safety reference, and the first complete lesson, exactly as a family would use it at the kitchen table. The rest of the year continues in the same shape: one complete lesson per spread, in any order you like.

- ◆ Every lesson built from the same six parts — once you know one, you know them all.
- ◆ The Autism Lens on every lesson: Make It Literal, Sensory Regulation, and Universal Design for Communication.
- ◆ Elite conversation starters tagged to the real moments of a day — each with a script to model first.
- ◆ Printable anchor charts and home tools, plus a Safety & Escalation band and a Parent Reflection on every lesson.

Take it home.

The complete The Foundation Home Edition — all 4 units • 28 lessons, undiluted — is available in the Store. A check-in, not an exam; a curriculum, not a worksheet.